

Executive Overview

Why this matters now

Recent UK data shows a quiet but significant revival in church engagement – especially among 18–24s and in multicultural urban settings. This summary translates that evidence into a 3-year growth plan for our new church plant.

Headline insights

- Young adults (18–24) are currently the most responsive group – monthly church attendance in this age band has risen roughly fourfold since 2018.
- Growth is driven by ethnic diversity: Black African/Caribbean and other minority communities are significantly more likely to attend and participate.
- High-traction UK churches (Holy Trinity Brompton, Jesus House, Ruach City Church, KICC, Hillsong UK) share common patterns: clear pathways, strong digital presence, multicultural worship and visible social impact.
- People exploring Christianity typically start online (Google/search) but the local church and Scripture are nearly as important in their journey.
- New UK churches usually start small (≈20–30 people) but can double in 3–5 years with consistent hospitality and a clear discipleship pipeline.

Age■Segment Strategy & Next Steps

Cross■cutting foundations (all ages)

- Visibility & digital funnel – launch a clean website, active Instagram and short■form video; clear ‘New here?’ path into an Alpha■style course. KPI (Year 1): 500 local web visits; 50% of first■time visitors heard of us online.
- Multicultural hospitality – diverse welcome and worship teams; refreshments and relational space after every service. KPI (Year 1): ≥50% of newcomers still attending after three visits.
- Discipleship pathway – 2–3 intro■to■faith courses per year, feeding directly into small groups and serving teams. KPI (Year 2): ≥60% of participants in groups; ≥30% serving somewhere.

By segment

- Youth (11–17): monthly high■energy youth night plus clear roles in band, media and kids' work. KPI (Year 3): 25+ regular teens with 5–8 baptisms/confirmations.
- Young adults (18–30): contextualised Alpha■style gatherings around purpose, anxiety and justice; young■adult groups and regular social■action projects. KPI (Year 3): 40+ regular 18–30s, most in groups and serving.
- Adults (31–50): family■friendly Sundays with strong children's ministry, marriage and parenting courses, and money/faith teaching. KPI (Year 3): 35–40 committed adults in this band; core budget covered by regular giving.
- Older adults (50+): blend some traditional elements into worship; mid■week daytime group, pastoral care, and mentoring roles. KPI (Year 3): 15–20 older adults, most active in prayer, hospitality or mentoring.

3■Year Targets & Success Metrics

Church■wide outcomes

- Attendance: grow from ≈30 to 80–100 regular attenders within three years.
- Diversity: ensure no single ethnic group represents more than 60% of the congregation; at least three major ethnic groups represented in visible leadership.
- Engagement: ≥65% of attenders in a small group and ≥50% serving in at least one ministry area.
- Spiritual fruit: 8–12 baptisms/confirmations per year from Year 3 onward, with a significant proportion from previously unchurched or de■churched backgrounds.

Next 90 days – immediate priorities

- Clarify target postcode(s), launch website and social channels, and set a date for the first intro■to■faith course.
- Recruit and train a small but diverse welcome/hosting team plus one youth/young■adult champion.
- Define measurement rhythm: monthly dashboard tracking attendance, newcomers, small group participation, serving and giving by age band.